

Planning starts with the reader

Audience → message → action

A PLAN MAKES YOUR CHOICES VISIBLE

1 / BRIEF

Audience +
action

2 / DIRECTION

Mood +
references

3 / OPTIONS

Sketch A +
sketch B

4 / TEST

Response +
revision

State who will see the ad and
what they should do.

The independent ad uses an actual
approved school/community
message.

Keep the first attempt. Explain the change using visible evidence.

Original teaching diagram · not a Photoshop interface

Individual check: Write: My audience is ___. After viewing, I want them to ___.

A mood board proposes a direction

Images + colour + type + tone

MOOD BOARD / WHAT IT COMMUNICATES

NORTHCOAST / QUIET MOMENT

Mood board: contextual desktop settings



Image treatment: calm, simple, one focal object

Colour roles: background, words, action

Type roles: headline, detail, tone

Annotations: why each choice serves this audience

Curate references and explain their purpose.

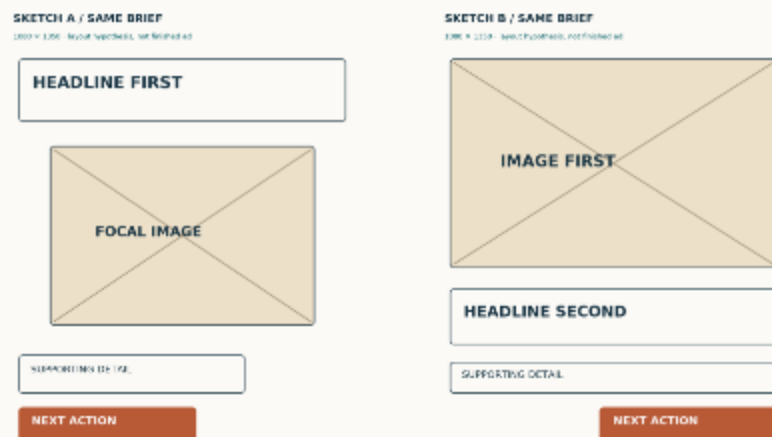
A board should help someone discuss the proposed direction.

Explain: visible feature → concept → purpose

An artboard is a canvas inside the file

One Photoshop document, several layouts

SAME DIRECTION · DIFFERENT READING ORDER



Teaching models drawn for this package. They do not depict Photoshop controls.

COMPARE A / B

Keep the audience, copy, palette and size fixed. Change the hierarchy.

Predict → ask a reader → record → revise

Keep mood, option A and option B together.

Artboards contain their own layers and clip content at their edges.

Explain: visible feature → concept → purpose

Explain the difference

Direction and arrangement answer different questions

MOOD BOARD / WHAT IT COMMUNICATES

NORTHCOAST / QUIET MOMENT

Mood board: conceptual direction settings



Image treatment: calm, simple, one focal object

Colour roles: background, words, action

Type roles: headline, detail, tone

Annotations: why each choice serves this audience

Mood: what should it feel like?
Sketch: where does information go?

You can create both on artboards.

Individual check: Choose: A direction/canvas; B final ad; C every layer. Explain.

Translate a reference into a choice

Visible feature → idea → reason

STUDY A FEATURE / MAKE YOUR OWN CHOICE



Follow the Arches / Cossette

Simplify the focal image.
Keep the message easy to find.



Recycle Me / Ogilvy

Study the relationship between
image and action text.



Public Theater / Pentagram

Energetic type may conflict
with our proposed calm tone.

Study one feature; design an original response.

Record creator/source and permission.

Actual campaign images · credited teaching/criticism · rights remain with owners · not measured audience results

Individual check: Name one reference feature and explain why it might serve your reader.

Give colour and type clear roles

Background · message · accent

MOOD BOARD / WHAT IT COMMUNICATES

NORTHCOAST / QUIET MOMENT

Mood board: contextual product settings



PALETTE ROLES



TYPE + TONE

Find your quiet moment
Simple sans serif / clear information
Calm - warm - uncluttered

WHY THESE REFERENCES?

One focal object and generous space support a calm tone. Dark words carry the message; the warm accent marks the action.

Original illustration © Orlan de la Hita & Proulx/Unsplash

Image treatment: calm, simple, one focal object

Colour roles: background, words, action

Type roles: headline, detail, tone

Annotations: why each choice serves this audience

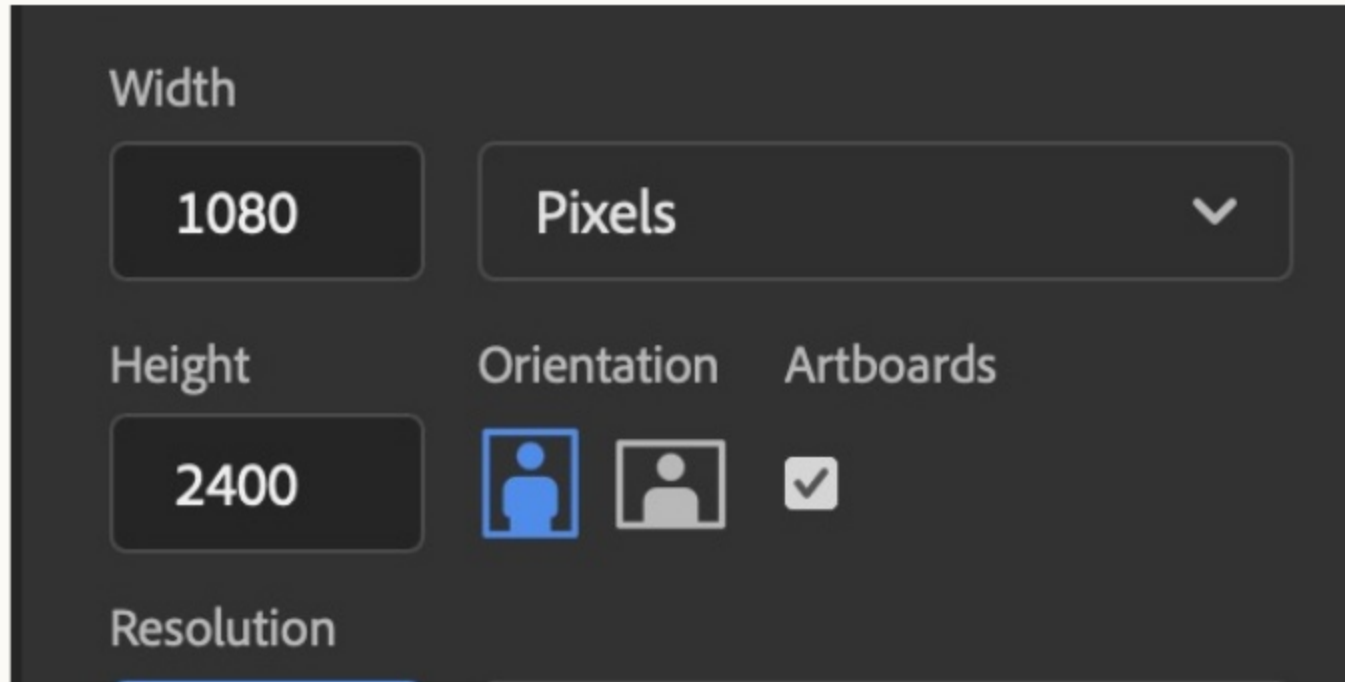
Annotate roles instead of listing favourites.

Keep words readable; the palette label does not prove contrast.

Explain: visible feature → concept → purpose

Check both artboard dimensions

1080 × 1350 px for this digital practice



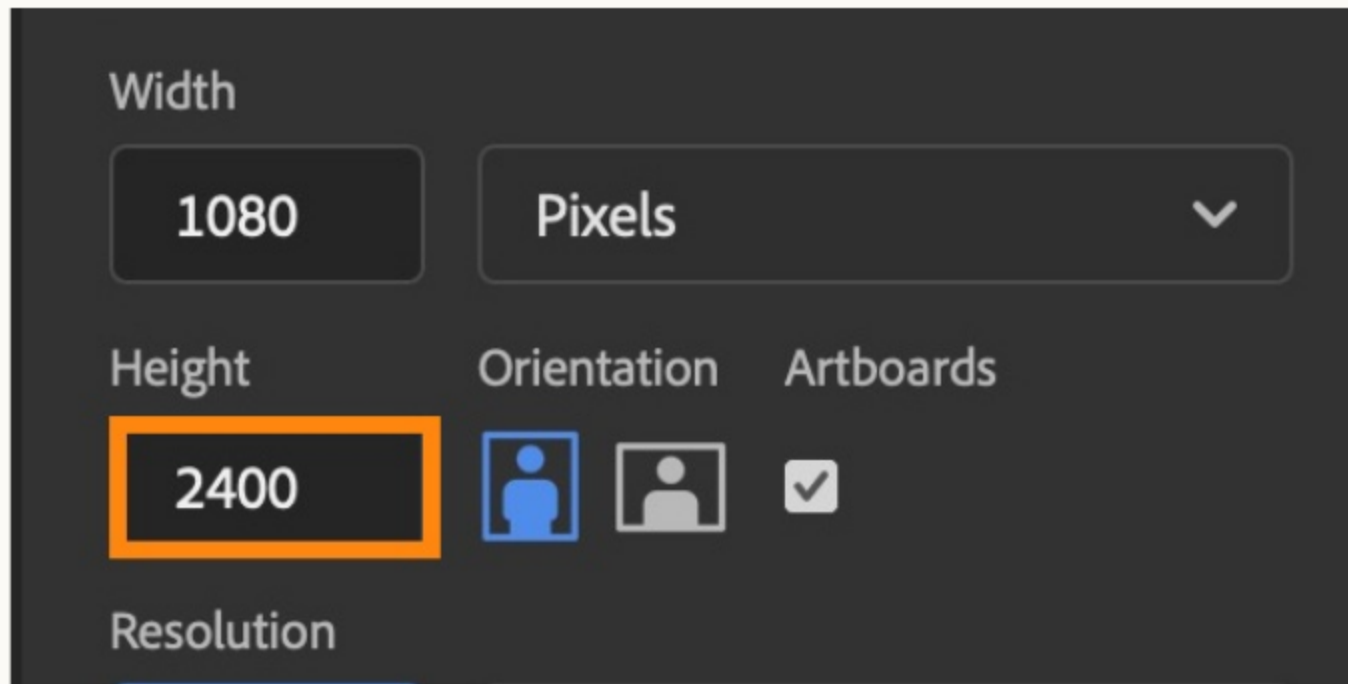
Use File → New, with Artboards enabled.

Genuine capture shows an incorrect inherited H 2400. Correction is pending.

Explain: visible feature → concept → purpose

Diagnose the setup mistake

Read the values, then target the cause



The screenshot shows the 'Artboards' panel in Adobe Photoshop. The 'Width' is set to 1080 and the unit is 'Pixels'. The 'Height' is set to 2400, which is highlighted with an orange border. The 'Orientation' is set to 'Portrait' (indicated by a blue icon). The 'Artboards' checkbox is checked. The 'Resolution' is set to 300 ppi.

The requested frame is 1080 × 1350.

Select the artboard; inspect W and H in Properties.

Individual check: Check: A artboard height; B text tracking; C PPI only. Explain.

Sketch before polishing

Compare two different reading orders

SAME DIRECTION · DIFFERENT READING ORDER

SKETCH A / SAME BRIEF
1200 x 1200 - layout unspecified, not finished yet



SKETCH B / SAME BRIEF
1200 x 1200 - layout unspecified, not finished yet



Teaching models drawn for this package. They do not depict Photoshop controls.

COMPARE A / B

Keep the audience, copy, palette and size fixed.
Change the hierarchy.

**Predict → ask a reader →
record → revise**

Use boxes and short labels for the important parts.

Keep the brief, copy, palette and size fixed.

Individual check: Make A and B differ in hierarchy. Predict first → second → third for each.

Ask a reader without coaching the answer

Notice → message → action

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Show A and B at the same size.

Record their actual words separately
from your prediction.

Keep the first attempt. Explain the change using visible evidence.

Original teaching diagram · not a Photoshop interface

Explain: visible feature → concept → purpose

Preserve the first idea and revise

One problem → one purposeful change

SAME DIRECTION · DIFFERENT READING ORDER

SKETCH A / SAME BRIEF
1200 x 1200 - layout unspecified, not finished yet



SKETCH B / SAME BRIEF
1200 x 1200 - layout unspecified, not finished yet



COMPARE A / B

Keep the audience, copy, palette and size fixed. Change the hierarchy.

Predict → ask a reader → record → revise

Keep A and B; duplicate the chosen direction.

Retest the change, then explain a tradeoff.

Teaching models drawn for this package. They do not depict Photoshop controls.

Individual check: Which feature would you change after feedback, and why?

Show the reasoning and the files

Direction → alternatives → evidence → revision

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Keep an editable PSD and review exports.

Native save/reopen and the independent cold run remain pending.

Keep the first attempt. Explain the change using visible evidence.

Original teaching diagram · not a Photoshop interface

Individual check: Evidence: A reader response + visible change; B completed steps; C file size. Explain.